

ROMESCADA

SEAFOOD STEW WITH ROMESCO

SERVES 4
AS A FIRST COURSE

At the base of *romescada* is one of the most widely used Spanish *picades*, *romesco*, made with roasted almonds, roasted garlic, roasted tomatoes, and the mild ñora chile. This classic quick stew works well as a starter, but you can also double the recipe to create a more substantial main course. I like to leave the heads on the cleaned shrimp because they add a lot of flavor to the dish. However, it helps to peel the shrimp to make them easier to eat in a shallow bowl.

- 1 tablespoon extra-virgin olive oil
- 1 tablespoon vegetable oil
- 8 head-on colossal (U-12 count) shrimp, peeled and deveined, tails left on
- 4 jumbo sea scallops
- 12 small clams, such as Manilas
- ½ cup Romesco (page 32) or store-bought romesco sauce
- 2 cups Fish Stock (page 35) or store-bought fish stock

- 1 In a large nonstick skillet, heat the oils over medium-high heat. When the oil is shimmering, add the shrimp and scallops and cook until the shrimp turn bright pink and the scallops are golden brown on both sides, about 4 minutes total, turning once. Remove to a plate and set aside.
- 2 In the same pan, combine the clams, romesco, and stock. Increase the heat to high, stirring to break up the romesco around the clams as it bubbles, and bring the sauce to a boil. Reduce the heat to medium and simmer until the clams open and the sauce has thickened enough to coat the seafood, about 8 minutes. (Discard any clams that do not open.)
- 3 Serve all the seafood in bowls with the sauce spooned over the top.

